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The Spokesman

Official Newsletter of the Badger Heritage Chapter
Antique Motorcycle Club of America

Fall - September 15, 2025

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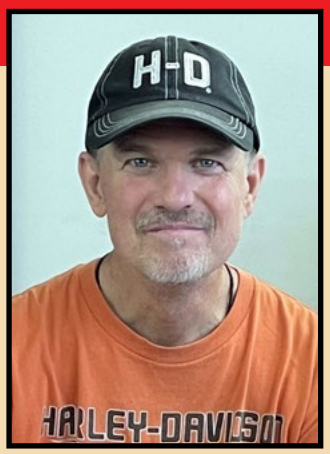
Badger Heritage Chapter
FALL MEETING
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2025 - 12 NOON

Cover Photo by Steve Strohmeier

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Presidents Message

Jon D. Oeflein - President



Hello Badgers!

This summer has disappeared faster than a low priced pile of NOS parts at Wauseon! I wish I could say that I had lots of motorcycle fun, but I didn't. As many of you are aware, I have a number of rental properties. Starting last fall, I had a bad run of issues that came my way. These situations required a lot of my time to get resolved and rectified. As of this month, I am happy to have things all in order again. I love the Badgers, but this is a hobby, and sometimes other things take precedence.

This busy work load left me unable to attend many of the events that I so enjoy. Last year I personally set our tent up at over ten events! This year however, I only managed to make it to half that many. This is disappointing to me, as I truly believe that the more our tent is up, the more members we sign up. It is that simple. This has played out in our new member numbers. They are still good but not as strong as last year. From what I have heard, we are still the largest chapter in the AMCA! I am proud of this as I strongly believe I had a hand in this achievement!

We have had a good year, with the exception of the Summer Picnic which was a disappointment. Kevin and Renee Klatt, as well as myself, put a great deal of work into planning our return to the Kettle Moraine Ranch for the 2025 party. The dates were booked, the caterer and the routes were in place, but less than 20 members expressed interest in attending. This was far short of our goal of 100. We heard many reasons from members as to why they weren't planning on going. Some of these were that they were too busy or had conflicts with other events. But the one we heard most is that they were not interested in camping and that there wasn't a viable hotel option. Leadership made the decision that we needed fifty members signed up to hold the event. We fell far short of this and therefore I made the decision to pull the plug. All I can do is learn from this and move forward.

One of the bright spots of the summer was the bike show that I planned at the new Davidson Park! We had almost forty bikes show up and everyone had a good time. The challenge coin that H-D had made for us was beautiful. Everyone received one as well as twenty-five dollars in vouchers for the BBQ truck! This is the second time I have organized a show at this new park which was named after my own family. I am proud to help the park out, and I am happy that the Badgers have shown such great enthusiasm as well!

Minutes before writing this letter, I was on the phone finalizing the plans for our Fall Meeting on October the 4th (see poster in this issue). We are having it at the Bad Moon Saloon in Milwaukee, and it is going to rock! Chris and Kristin Grave own this popular spot. They are both fans of vintage motorcycles. Chris spent ten years at the Motor Company and has also built some cool bikes of his own. He is friends with numerous Badgers. I am happy I finally met him at the Stoopid Chopper Show (which was a blast). I am making my Sloppy Jono Sandwiches, so come hungry!

I just want to remind everyone that our elections will be held at the meeting. Secretary and Vice President have both served their two-year terms. If you are interested in running for or voting on either of these positions, you must attend the meeting. We will also be covering lots of other topics so please come and lend a hand in shaping the future of our chapter!

Your President,
Jono



Badger Heritage Chapter

FALL MEETING

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2025
12 NOON



SLOPPY JONO
SANDWICHES ON
SHEBOYGAN
HARD ROLLS
AND
VIENNA BEEF
HOT DOGS
AND
PASTA SALAD
AND
DILL PICKLES

BAD MOON SALOON
4035 SOUTH CLEMENT AVENUE, MILWAUKEE, WIS. 53207

BAR WILL BE OPEN AND LUNCH WILL BE SERVED
ELECTIONS FOR VICE PRESIDENT AND SECRETARY

CONTACT JON DAVIDSON OEFLEIN
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Ohio State Reformatory - Mansfield, Ohio - 6/7-8/25

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



This summer, the Midwest welcomed a new kind of motorcycle show—one that traded fairgrounds for cell blocks and swapped convention halls for prison yards. The first-ever Party at The Pen East took over the historic Ohio State Reformatory, famously known as the filming location for The Shawshank Redemption, and turned it into a two-day celebration of vintage motorcycles, community, and pure adrenaline.

Inside the prison walls, over 200 bikes were displayed in hauntingly beautiful cell blocks and corridors. Outside, more than 500 bikes filled the yard, surrounded by vendors, food trucks, tattoo artists, and the roaring spectacle of the Wall of Death—a live-action thrill show featuring daredevils riding vertically in a wooden cylinder.

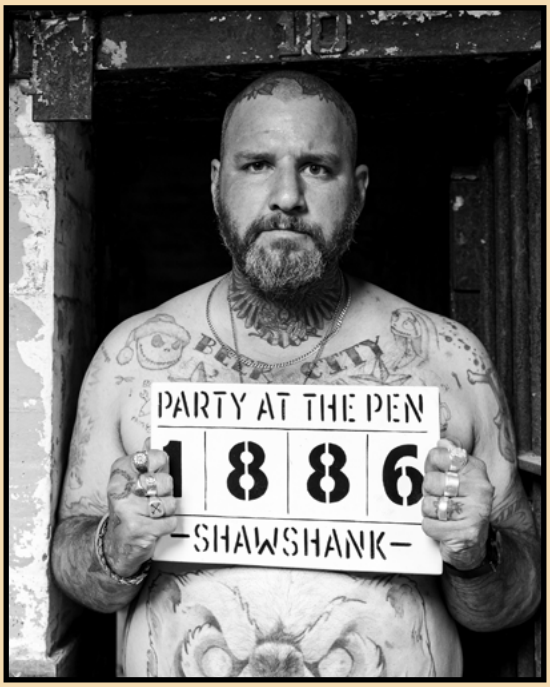
Built between 1886 and 1910, the Ohio State Reformatory was designed to inspire rehabilitation through architecture. It operated until 1990 and gained international fame as the filming location for The Shawshank Redemption, starring Tim Robbins and Morgan Freeman. Today, it's preserved by the Mansfield Reformatory Preservation Society, and for one weekend in June, it became the most unforgettable venue for a motorcycle show in the country.

Packed up the Mama Tried van with Brian and Matt, thanks to Scott Johnson, who generously lent us the wheels. We hit the road with beers in the cooler, good music on the stereo, and a mission to make memories. We camped in the van, met new and old friends, and brought back a Big Twin Flathead project for Scott.

My 1951 WL Flathead Chopper was proudly displayed inside the prison, part of the official show lineup. The atmosphere was surreal—vintage bikes framed by iron bars and limestone walls, echoing with history and horsepower. I had the honor of meeting Michael Lichter, who photographed my bike, and was interviewed by his son, adding another layer of connection to the experience.

Continued on next page.







Ohio State Reformatory - Mansfield, Ohio - 6/7-8/25

Story by Chris Gunns



The Lake Erie AMCA Chapter added serious flavor to the event with a swap meet organized by their chapter VP, Kerry. It was a treasure trove of vintage parts, rare finds, and good conversation. Whether you were hunting for a hard-to-find carb or just soaking up the stories, the swap meet was a highlight.

When the sun went down, the energy turned up. The after-parties were wild—packed with music, tattoos, and the kind of camaraderie that only comes from shared miles and shared beers. It was the kind of weekend that blurs into legend.

Party at The Pen East is the sister show to Party at The Pen West, held at the Old Idaho State Penitentiary in Boise. Both events are organized by the same passionate crew, whose mission is to celebrate vintage motorcycle culture in unforgettable venues. From the cell blocks of Shawshank to the high desert of Idaho, they're building something truly special.

If this year was any indication, Party at The Pen East is destined to become a staple in the vintage motorcycle circuit. Whether you're rolling in with a build, camping with your crew, or just chasing the thrill of the ride, this is one show you won't want to miss.

Chris Gunns









Tales from the Road: Sammy Miller Motorcycle Museum

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



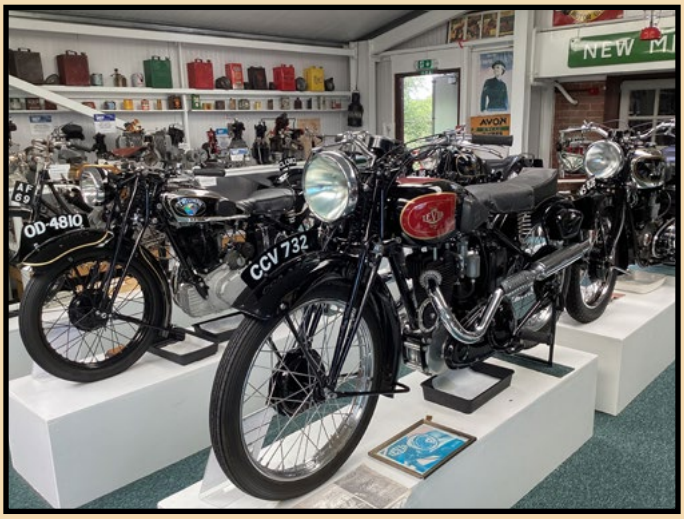
Earlier this summer, I found myself in England on a business trip with a day to myself. It gave me the perfect opportunity to hop a train to New Milton on the south coast and visit the Sammy Miller Motorcycle Museum.



Sammy Miller is the single most winning international motorcycling competitor. From 1949 to 1989, Sammy won more than 1400 professional events and 11 British championships, doing so on a wide variety of brands from NSU to Honda. While most of his victories came in Trials, Sammy also was a highly competitive road racer, enjoying six podium finishes in 14 grand prix races from 1955 to 1958. He's most famous for achieving a string of several hundred victories on GOV182, an Ariel 500 Sammy personally modified. He was so successful in developing GOV182 that Bultaco hired Sammy to develop the Sherpa and Honda later did the same for their off-road bikes. Sammy's ability to constantly engineer a better solution and then ride his solution to a win is nearly unmatched in motorcycle history.



In the late 1970s, Sammy began collecting unusual motorcycles, principally British and European. This collection grew to include extremely rare competition bikes sourced from Sammy's numerous friends and contacts. Much like George Barber, Sammy set out to build something truly remarkable around a unique collection. Today, the Museum boasts more than 550 bikes, many of which are the only known running examples and often the only example, period. The collection is also wide, covering bikes from circa 1894 to the present. Unlike most motorcycle museums, you will see things at the Miller Museum you literally cannot see anywhere else on earth.



However, even if bikes are not your bag, the Museum has something for you. First, there is the train journey from London to the New Forest and Isle of Wight. The scenery is lovely and the ride is a relaxing 90 minutes.

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Tales from the Road: Sammy Miller Motorcycle Museum

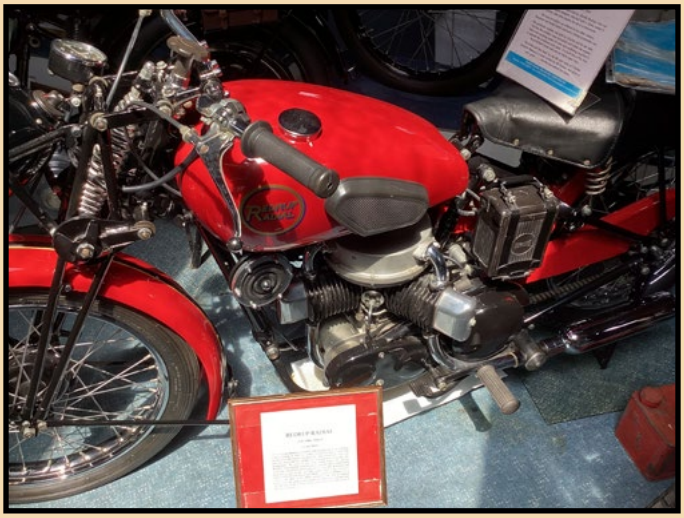
Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



New Milton itself is a cute hamlet with a typical village center and farm fields all around. It is only 3 miles from the south coast of England. The Museum sits tucked on a hobby farm, complete with tame llama, donkeys, alpaca, ducks, and goats eager to meet visitors. There's an excellent cafe (Sammy's Pit Stop) which just opened in May 2025, several local craft shops, and all sorts of petroliana which can be visited without buying a ticket. And, if you are so inclined, it is a beautiful 1.8 mile walk from the train station to the Museum via public footpaths through the New Forest.



On arriving at the Museum, it really does feel more like a farm than motorcycling heaven. Once you step through the doors, however, it is a different world. I was immediately struck by two questions: 1) what are half these bikes! and 2) why doesn't it smell like old grease and mothballs in here? The answer to the first question will take you at least half a day. There were probably 100 bikes so obscure as to make you wonder. The answer to the second question is very easy, none of the bikes are mothballed. All but a few are runners and kept ready for action save fuel. So, they don't smell like old bikes in storage, they smell like bikes that just came in for an overnight. The Museum regularly demonstrates irreplaceable bikes at historic events and races. They also loan bikes to classic magazine testers. If you've read an article by Alan Cathcart in a British classic bike magazine in the last 30 years, chances are Alan was riding a bike from the Museum.



As you start wandering around, you notice every inch of floor and wall space is taken up. From sectional motors to memorabilia, it is a visual overload of unusual stuff. The displays are mostly arranged by decade and continent or country. My personal favorite halls were the Italian Hall and the 1930s British competition bikes. Both were just phenomenal and I enjoyed seeing examples of some of my very own bikes in Sammy's collection! I particularly enjoyed a lineup of Scott's demonstrating the evolution of this often pioneering brand.



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Tales from the Road: Sammy Miller Motorcycle Museum

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



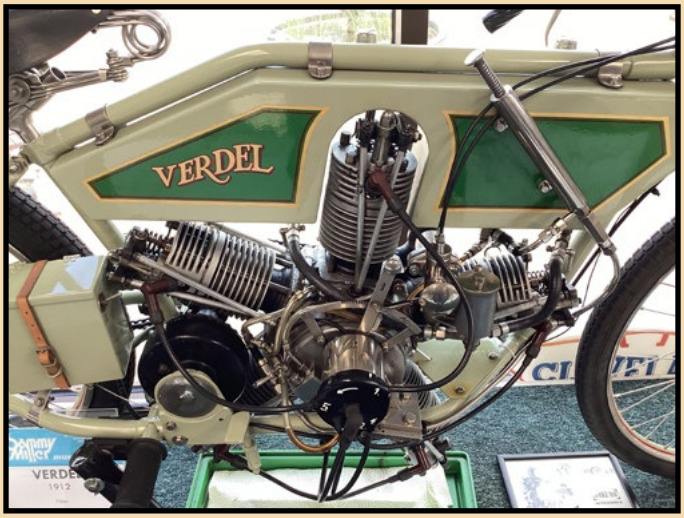
Unlike many other motorcycle museums, the Miller Museum also allows enthusiasts to get as close as possible to bikes without sitting on them. Another highlight of the visit was spending a few minutes with Sammy. He works 10am to 4pm six days a week in the Museum's restoration shop. At 92, he's faster with a spanner than people 1/3rd his age and his boyish charm shines right through. It was a treat seeing him set up throttles knowing how rare it is to watch the most winning trials rider in history wrench on a bike. The team also was working on a Rickman Trident while I was visiting They explained the rarity . . . and four weeks later another Rickman Trident appeared at Wauseon! Talk about coincidence.

If you find yourself in the UK and within 100 miles of Southampton, consider making a day trip to visit the Sammy Miller Museum. You won't be disappointed!

Speedy Safely!

Steve Strohmeier









From the Desk of the Newsletter Editor

Life-saver by Steve Peters





Hey Badgers!

I'm going to start by apologizing as this will be very off topic and will have nothing to do with antique motorcycles or even motorcycling in general. I just feel the need to share this story with everyone as it has deeply affected me and will be with me the rest of my life.

In August, I saved the life of a good friend of mine.

I posted about this on Facebook, so some of you may be familiar with the story, but it was brief and there is so much more to say.

I will start with some background first. As many of you know I am a WWII reenactor and from 8/14/25 to 8/17/25 I was at the world's largest D-Day invasion reenactment with about 1500 reenactors and 10,000 spectators in Conneaut, Ohio along the shore of Lake Erie.

It was a great event with a huge reenactor encampment, vendors, WWII veterans, WWII vehicles and much more to see including three days of beach battles on Thursday, Friday, and Saturday as well as several smaller inland skirmishes.

I was there with a few of my friends from our 9th I.D. unit back here in Wisconsin and Illinois as we joined another unit of guys from the Ohio area making a group of about 20 or so. I didn't know any of the guys from the unit we joined, but after living with them and being in battle together for a few days everyone quickly becomes good friends and I very much feel a strong bond with them.

On Saturday evening the event hosts a USO style dance for the event participants and a good size group from our unit attended the dance in our finest dress uniforms and we all had a great time. After the dance three of us went to a local bar joining some other reenactors for one more and then we headed back to camp at about 2am to our large tent.

After one friend and I were settling in on our cots, our other friend went out to his car behind the tent where we had three of our cars parked. He told me he taking off his uniform and putting it in his car at the time when he started choking.

Quoted from my friend: "I could feel that the food didn't quite go all the way down when I tried to swallow, but I could still breathe initially. I didn't think much of it and took a sip of water at my car to wash it down, but that somehow pushed the obstruction into my throat and the water came out my mouth since my throat was blocked. That's when I knew I had a serious problem and started running to the tent."

A minute or so later I heard him running next to the tent and then into the tent. He turned around and was holding his throat. Quoted from him "I was making the universal signal for choking with my hands when I was in the tent to try to let you all know what was happening."

As there was no time to lose and every second counts, I jumped up as he turned his back to me and I started to perform the Heimlich Maneuver with a few thrusts. He then bent over and tried to cough to dislodge the object as water and saliva came from his mouth. He then said "Again", so I tried a few more thrusts after he straightened up. Then he bent over again and coughed with similar results. Then he straightened and motioned to go outside.

While outside he seemed to breathe a little better and wanted me to do it again and then a fourth time. Finally he took a few good breaths and could talk a little telling us he tried to take a drink of water to help at first. Apparently the water was only stopped by the obstruction which caused only gurgling sounds of air escaping from his lungs through a very small opening and not allowing him to get any good breaths. He stood straight up and raised his arms above his head and took a few very good, deep breaths.

Maybe it was just a coincidence or fate that I was there that night. At one point during the day Saturday I was going to join the guys from my 9th I.D. unit to stay in a local hotel for the night, but then I decided not to and wanted to just stay in camp. I'm sure the other guys there could have done what was needed, but I am very happy that I was able to get him the help he needed and I saved his life that night and we have a very happy ending. It was the first time I ever saved anyones life.

Later that morning when I was doing the 9 hour drive home it really started to sink in as I thought of what might have happened had I not been there. I get very emotional just thinking about the possibility of losing someone I really care about. Even while writing this I have needed to stop a few times.

A lot of things go through your mind when things like this happen. What would have happed if he was alone or the other guys in the tent or outside did not know what to do or panicked? We had only seconds to get him some air, so it was important to act quickly. Up until a few days earlier he was just someone from another state that I certainly did not know and he did not know me.

By the end of the event and having "lived" with the boys for the duration I developed some new friendships with the guys as well as him, so when this emergency happened it instantly became very personal as I would consider him and the rest of the crew as good friends that I care a great deal for. Even now, I continue to think about that night every day.

Thank God I will be able to see him at future events as I believe we now have a unique bond that we did not ask for, but will only make our friendship a little more special.

Take care and stay safe!

Steve Peters

3rd Annual Beer City Cycles Bike Show & BBQ - Milwaukee, WI - 6/21/25

Story by Chris Gunns - Photos by Jeff Hill, Chris Gunns, and Tommy



Under a blazing summer sun, Chris Gunns, Badgers AMCA member and owner of Beer City Cycles, led his crew in throwing one of Milwaukee's most unforgettable grassroots motorcycle events. The third annual Beer City Cycles Bike Show & BBQ drew over 100 bikes and nearly 300 attendees, proving once again that when community, craftsmanship, and cold beer collide… magic happens.



Built in 1872, Puddlers Hall is one of Milwaukee's oldest taverns, originally serving as a meeting place for ironworkers—known as "puddlers"—who forged the city's industrial backbone. Today, it stands as a beloved community hub, where tradition meets grit and good times flow freely. Its vintage charm and storied walls made it the perfect setting for a day that celebrated authenticity, artistry, and the kind of bikes that turn heads and spark conversations.



"There's something about Puddlers that feels like home. You walk in and it's like stepping into a time machine—with better beer."
— Mike R., attendee and Panhead owner.

With temperatures soaring past 90°F, the crowd found relief in ice-cold Busch Beer and the smoky goodness of NotBad BBQ. Raffle prizes flew off the tables, beers were crushed, and the vibe stayed electric from the first bike roll-in to the last tattoo at the after-party.



The bikes? Pure art. From knuckleheads to shovelheads, rat rods to pristine restorations, the lot was packed with personality and pride. The Beer City Cycles crew brought the heat, and Steven, a Badgers member, stole the show with his 1946 EL Knucklehead, "Bella," earning Best of Show honors and a chorus of cheers from the crowd.

"That bike had soul (Bella). You don't just build a bike like that—you live it."
— Tasha L., raffle winner and first-time attendee.

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3rd Annual Beer City Cycles Bike Show & BBQ - Milwaukee, WI - 6/21/25

Story by Chris Gunns - Photos by Jeff Hill, Chris Gunns, and Tommy



When the sun dipped low, the party kept rolling at Bad Moon Saloon. DJs spun gritty sets, tattoos were inked on-site, and the beer kept flowing—free, of course. It was the kind of night that blurs into legend, where stories are born and friendships are sealed over shared rides and shared laughs.



"Free beer, fresh ink, and a DJ who actually knew what to play? That after-party was next level."
— Jorge M., Street Glide rider 2nd year attendee

This show wouldn't be possible without the incredible support of our sponsors. Their generosity helped keep the event free, inclusive, and unforgettable:



Busch Beer • Beechwood Sales • M Harper Music • Curry Surr • Bike Works Milwaukee • Strange Bird MFG • Kelvis Art • Thug Inc • Arrow MFG • Cowboy Butts Drive Me Nuts • Badgers AMCA • Stupid Rad • Rattler Branding Co • Odin MFG • Peps Draft Haus • Old Bones Therapy • Fuel Moto • Zylstra Choppers • Flat Out Friday • Greasy Reaper • Street Syndicate MFG • NotBad Foods • Lady Cannon Co • Speed Trap Choppers • Milwaukee Benny • Nick Haints • Gremlin Wiring • Lowbrow Customs • Meathook Leatherworks • Deadbeat Customs • Heartland MFG • Experimental God Designs • Doc Cycles Service & Restoration • Fast Eddy Co • Overdrive Defense • Wisco Throttle



The next Beer City Cycles Bike Show & BBQ is already locked in:
June 13, 2026.
Same grit. Same heart. New stories waiting to be written.

Whether you're rolling in on two wheels or just coming for the vibes, mark your calendar and get ready to ride.

Photos by Jeff Hill, Chris Gunns, Tommy.

Chris Gunns

Celebrating a Century of Italian Motorcycling - Part 2

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



In the spring 2025 Spokesman we briefly touched on the history of Benelli, one of two Italian motorcycle makers in production for more than 100 years. For 30 years I hunted for a Benelli Tornado 650, finding one unexpectedly at a friend's shop in Denver. We pick up the second part of the story with the Rocky Mountain Chapter's 2025 Cliffhanger Road Run.



Throughout the winter, my Tornado - now named Uncle Ben - got a thorough once over to wake him up from 35 years of slumber. We fit new tires and a battery, changed fluids, and replaced several bulbs. With that done, Uncle Ben fired on the third kick and received some shakedown miles. He proved fuss free and was proclaimed ready to roll. Still, the question remained: just how well would an exotic small bore twin, which hadn't been used in decades, perform on a three-day, 600 mile road run with elevation changes from 6,000-12,000 feet? Adding to the pressure, there was no trouble truck for the road run and many roads we would ride had no shoulders, as well as narrow lanes.



With these questions ringing in my ears, I excitedly unloaded Uncle Ben at our base camp in Gunnison, Colorado. I had not seen the bike in four years and I was immediately struck by how small it seemed. However, the second I hopped on, it fit like a glove. The second thing I noticed is that the gauges are counter-rotating. That took a little bit to get used to seeing!



It was a beautiful sunny afternoon and after unloading we still had four hours to kill before other Rocky Mountain chapter members began arriving. My buddy Kurt and I decided to take our bikes on a quick 70-mile run to Taylor Reservoir and back.

We made a right out of the Road Run's base camp onto US Hwy 50, immediately finding ourselves on a 65 mph road. That's when I learned my first Tornado ownership lesson; the gap between first and second gear is HUGE. It is such a large gap you wonder if you accidentally shifted to third, but then I found second through fifth are perfectly spaced.

Continued on next page.

Celebrating a Century of Italian Motorcycling - Part 2

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



I then learned lesson two, for a 480 pound bike, Uncle Ben flies. I swore the speedometer was at least 15 mph optimistic. As we ripped up a tight box canyon towards the reservoir, I truly thought the speedo lied. It kept saying we were rolling much faster than the recommended limit on curves; yet I never came close to touching pegs and barely used the brakes. However, when we got to the reservoir, my buddy came over and noted our speed. The GPS in my pocket confirmed the speedometer was not lying. Uncle Ben is a deceptively fast canyon carver. You just don't expect it when looking at the bike.



No good time goes unpunished, however, and Uncle Ben decided to fluff off several times on the way back from the reservoir. I neglected to check the fuel level before we left out and it was much lower than expected. When combined with spirited, often WOT riding, I drained the fuel in no time flat. I limped the poor bike about 8 miles on one cylinder before coasting to the nearest fuel station. The bike took 3.1 gallons in a 3.2 gallon tank! I never knew it was possible to drain a tank that low on reserve!



Our first day of riding on the road run was a 140-mile "out and back" run from Gunnison over Cottonwood Pass to Buena Vista. We had 24 total riders on everything from a Vincent Black Shadow to a CB750 Chopper to a bone stock Honda Rebel 250. The road to Cottonwood is a fun, looping route that only recently received full pavement! It was a perfect way to start the run as the road continuously trades places with a fork of the Gunnison River, creating a series of small valleys and scenic turnouts that have to be seen to be believed. The route also returned us to Taylor Reservoir, a stunning body of water that evokes John Denver's "Rocky Mountain High." The Reservoir provided a perfect stopping place before the 15 mile run to the top of Cottonwood at 12,100 feet, where we had an impromptu snowball fight. After a lunch stop in Buena Vista we all enjoyed a terrific run back to Gunnison.



Continued on next page.

Celebrating a Century of Italian Motorcycling - Part 2

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



However, my left cylinder kept cutting out after our stop on top of Cottonwood and for much of the ride to Buena Vista I swore I was running out of gas again. It didn't make sense I would be out of fuel again and topping up revealed I had 1.5 gallons left. Jiggling the petcock seemed to get the left working again, only for the bike to sputter randomly. Getting back to base camp, we tore into the carbs and petcocks. The left petcock was completely plugged with junk. Only a trickle of fuel flowed. We flushed the tank and an amazing amount of crud came out. After cleaning the fuel bowls and jets, I also lowered the needles to lean the mixture for altitude. It took less than an hour to finish the surgery. All that done, Uncle Ben roared to life on the first kick and was instantly 100 percent happier.



Our second day saw the crew take a 170-mile round trip up the north rim of the Black Canyon to Hotchkiss. This particular route takes riders through the alpine range and above the tree line before dropping back onto a high plains mesa. It has all the switchbacks, sweepers, elevation, and temperature changes one could want in a ride. I had the joy of leading this ride on Uncle Ben, together with an Ironhead Sportster, a Vincent Black Shadow, an Indian Chief, and a BMW R100S. We all stopped to take in the view at Hermit's Rest before pushing on to Hotchkiss for an excellent lunch at Zack's BBQ.



On the way back from Hotchkiss, it was requested by a small group that we leave early and "up the pace" for the ride back. With that missive I kicked over the Benelli and tore out towards the mountains. As we hit the deserted mesa, I wound the Benelli WOT hitting a true 88mph on the GPS with ease with the bike still pulling and the Black Shadow growling near me . . . and then suddenly finding myself with a dead bike. The power wire to the ignition coil had snapped off! With the help of the group, we spliced a chunk of wire in and had Uncle Ben back on the road in less than five minutes! We returned to our "brisk" pace enjoying a gorgeous and drama free ride back.



Continued on next page

Celebrating a Century of Italian Motorcycling - Part 2

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



Our final day of riding was a 140-mile round trip to Lake City and the Slumgullion Pass. Slumgullion is the steepest (9%), highest (11,500 feet) continuously paved road in Colorado. It is an enormous challenge for any vintage motorbike to climb. The ride to the pass was simply outstanding. We had zero clouds in the sky and a trailing wind the entire way. After stopping for photos at the pass, we headed back down the mountain to Lake City. The town is infamous as the site of the Alferd Packer massacre. Packer, later known as the "Colorado Cannibal," ate five men he was guiding during the winter of 1874. Being history buffs, we had lunch at the Packer Saloon where the motto is: Al Killed 'Em, We Grill 'Em. The Cannibal Salad is quite good.



The ride back to Gunnison was completed in silent awe of the scenery. When we got to base camp, I checked the GPS. It noted I had rolled a total of 624 miles on Uncle Ben at an average speed of 48.6 mph. Uncle Ben used no oil, got around 40 mpg despite spirited riding, and even when unhappy – he still started in one or two kicks.

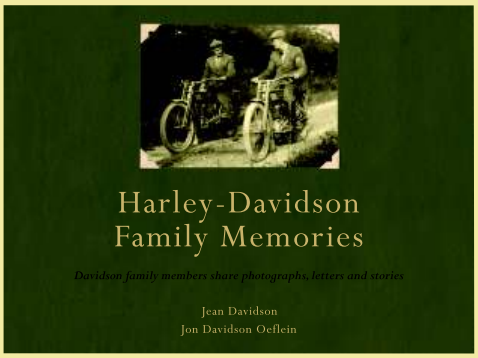


Uncle Ben is simply a terrific bike and an ideal vintage commuter. After shaking out its few faults, the bike really woke up and was just FUN to ride. I developed a huge amount of confidence in the bike over the course of the road run and never doubted Uncle Ben would get me home. The Benelli is also the first bike I have gotten in a long time where I do not want to change a thing. I just want to go riding and wear out tires. I guess after a century – Benelli knows how to build a good bike!



Speed Safely!

Steve Strohmeier



COME TAKE A JOURNEY THROUGH TIME WITH PERSONAL STORIES AND RARE FAMILY PHOTOS OF THE HARLEY-DAVIDSON FOUNDERS AND THEIR FAMILIES.

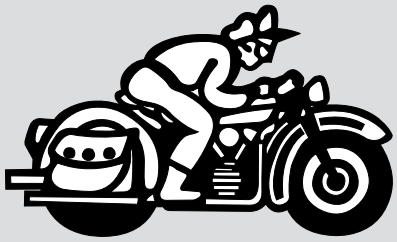


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Midwest Muscle Meets the Upper Peninsula - Apocalypse Run

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



Now in its 18th year, the Apocalypse Run—organized by Zylstra Choppers—is a chopper-heavy pilgrimage that kicks off in Sparta, Michigan, crosses the mighty Mackinac Bridge (what I consider a human cheese greater!), and lands in Strongs, MI at Strongs Tavern and Motel, owned by the ever-hospitable Heather. This guys-only trip, jokingly dubbed "Boyfriends Weekend," is all about choppers, chaos, and friendship. Some camp, others crash in the motel, but everyone's there for the same thing: Midwest muscle choppers and unforgettable memories.

Continued on next page





Midwest Muscle Meets the Upper Peninsula - Apocalypse Run

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



Even though this was a chopper party, I rode solo on my 2011 Street Glide—no chase truck, no backup. As my good friend Kerry says, "You need a bike for every kind of ride," and this one called for reliability and saddlebags that could hold cold beer. I left Friday morning up the Wisconsin side, clocking nearly 1,300 miles round trip. The sun rose blood red through the fog, and the views of Lake Michigan were unreal. At the Clark Motel up the road, the secondary party spot featured a flaming bowling ball dropped three stories into a gas bucket. We broke off into rides to nearby towns, swam in Lake Superior, and cliff-dived at the local quarry. Heather worked open to close, cooking breakfast and dinner for the crew, while a band played Friday night and raffles on Saturday raised money for charity and downed riders—thanks to Zylstra's generosity.

Continued on next page





Midwest Muscle Meets the Upper Peninsula - Apocalypse Run

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



We drank thousands of beers, gambled at Ceelow, fixed bikes together, and made memories that'll last a lifetime. Apocalypse Run isn't just a party it's much more! The memories and friendships you build at this event are epic!

Chris Gunns







Badger Heritage Chapter

7th ANNUAL

POKEY RUN

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 27, 2025
10AM START



Case Eagle Park - 304 South Rochester Street
Burlington, Wis. 53105



Coffee and Donuts at 9am - Ride begins at 10 am - 35 miles of scenic and slow riding pleasure
Lunch stop at the famous Bunker Bar and Grill - Returning back to the starting location

Please bring your strange and slow machines to this event
Trouble trucks will follow the slow parade of fun
If you have a pair of bib overhauls wear them in honor of John Bibs Smallwood,
as this was one of his favorite events
Hope to see you there

Jim Feyereisen - (920) 980-1161



From the Archives - Number 5

Dan Krause - Chapter Historian



In this issue of "From the Archives", we are going to look at the year 2003. The chapter is now 15 years old, and we are probably at right around 100 members. The Harley 100th was a big deal that year and many of the Badgers rode their old iron in the parades migrating towards Milwaukee. The Badger Chapter gathered at incoming President Jared Millen's "What's Fresh" Deli on Saturday for primo parking and access to the downtown festivities. The week prior, many Badgers could be found at the Rocker Box Motorcycle Show and street party on Center Street. That show was an eclectic mix of Euro, Japanese, English, American and custom motorcycles all in one place. I remember the "scooter gang" that rode into the show, there had to be well over a hundred of them! Lambretta, Piaggio, Bridgestone and Vespa just to name a few, very kool and unique.

Anyway, what I really want to highlight is the 2003 Edition of the Summer Picnic. As we all know, the annual Summer Picnic has long been the "main event" for the chapter for many years. This event was the "glue" that brought many of the chapter members together each year to do what we like to do best: ride our old motorcycles and share our good-fellowship. Often, this was the one time each year we could meet up with members that were maybe not as close as we would like. I'll let Chris Bilda tell the story as he wrote it in the 2003 Fall Edition of the Spokesman:

"The sound of new Harley-Davidson's is all too familiar around the Waterford area on any given summer weekend. One particular day last June, local residents bent their ears to a bombardment of mechanical sounds uncommon in such numbers. Antique motorcycles of all makes and models descended upon the Waterford area for the annual Badger Heritage Picnic hosted by Cindy, Ruby and me. Near perfect weather brought members, significant others and friends from all directions.

Continued on next page.



The late Bob Kiefer is checking out this nice '65 Panhead with a very nice Triumph gleaming in the background.



This is Al Feyereisen's early Panhead and 1/2 of the "Feyereisen Gang" that influenced Tony Huelter to do some ditch riding with his Knucklehead.



Not sure who is piloting this very nice WL (maybe Russ Scharrer?) but he's getting ready to drop some balls on cone!

From the Archives - Number 5

Dan Krause - Chapter Historian



The picnic feast prepared by Cindy, as well as dishes brought by others, filled all to content. Once again, Krause Korn on the Kob made toothpicks a mandatory party favor. Mike Golembiewski provided lunch entertainment in the form of the Knuth Harley-Davidson family videos. He also took willing riders for a short tour of the local landscape and a long tour of a local tavern. Rumors persist in the Waterford area about Mike buying the first round, but they are unsubstantiated and are only heard around late night campfires.

Field events were preceded by an enduro ride around the pond and through the woods on extensive trails throughout the property. Indians, knuckleheads, full dress panheads, chopper, stock, euro, jap all broke the bonds of asphalt and tried their hand at cross country daredevilry. Apparently overcome by the water crossing scenes of the Knuth videos, outgoing president Tony Hueltner attempted a marsh crossing aided by a narrow path and the oncoming panheads of the Feyereisen brothers! A perfect imprint of Tony and his knucklehead remained in the mud and tall grass for days afterward. Both managed to dry off in the hot sun before the long ride home.

Many riders tested their skills in the field events, which consisted of placing tennis balls on cones, the welding helmet ride, slow race and plank ride. The winners of each event escaped my memory, but it was nice to see the increased participation of old and new members. Bikes ranged from 100-point restorations to originals and parts bikes. New member Larry Bilda piloted his home built Bild-A-Motorbike to fame in the welding helmet ride and after I did a little trimming on the pine trees, you can't even tell where he finished!

Continued on next page.



I'm pretty sure this is Dave Derler's "black beauty" Big Twin Flattie. Dave and this beauty were regulars at Badger events.



Just a beautiful example of a 40's Knucklehead with some kool decorative "doo-da's". Anyone remember who's ride this was?



Here's the famous "FireGlide" bike piloted by Ed "The Blaze" Feyereisen as he readies himself for some field game action. Shortly after his field run is when the excitement really began...

From the Archives - Number 5

Dan Krause - Chapter Historian



An unexpected brief intermission in the field events occurred when Ed Feyereisen's panhead caught fire. With the terrible thought of watching a Hydra-Glide burn to the ground, members took immediate action. As I headed for a fire extinguisher in the garage, others bravely emptied their beer cans, soda cups and the entire contents of two coolers on the now blazing panhead. Just as Ed was seen reaching for his zipper, I arrived in time with the extinguisher and saved everyone from the shocking spectacle about to develop! Amazingly, the bike was pushed up to the house, washed off and ridden home 50-60 miles!

Long after most club members had left, stragglers enjoyed a late campfire with Ed Bieri on his Duo-Glide and me on my Indian riding the enduro trails in the dark. I can't speak for Ed, but I think I'm going to cut a few trees and maybe widen the bridge before I do that again! Thanks to all who helped make the 2003 Badger Heritage Picnic one we will all remember for years to come."

You are exactly right Chris, it's 22 years later, great memories…

LOOKING FOR OLD ISSUE'S OF THE SPOKESMAN! The archives need help to fill in some gaps we have in our old newsletters. If anyone has Spokesman issues from 2010 through 2014 it would be much appreciated to get a copy for the Badger Chapter Archives. Also, if you have any old photos of past chapter events you'd like to share, the archives would be happy for those as well.

Thanks much!

Dan



This Chief was too pretty to be Chris Bilda's!



Couple of nice panheads, Ed Bieri's 1960 and a beauty '64 behind that.



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Spokesman Stories

Calling All Members!

I am always looking for more content for the Spokesman newsletter.

I know many of you attend various events and take photos and have a story to tell. I see the photos on Facebook all the time and just wish you could send at least a dozen of those photos to me with a short story about the event. We would all like to see and hear what our memebers are doing.

I will no longer ask individuals for photos and a story as I would like to leave it up to them if they choose to send anything or not.

If you need help with your story I can help and will always do a punctuation and spell check of the stories and may edit them a little as well.

Thanks! Newsletter Editor - Steve Peters

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